

Ebonye Smith

University of California, Berkeley

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control theory · safe learning and decision-making · machine learning · autonomous systems · formal methods

Research Position

University of California, Berkeley

GRADUATE STUDENT RESEARCHER

Electrical Engineering and Computer Sciences
Claire J. Tomlin and Gireeja Ranade (Advisors)

Berkeley, CA, US
08/2022 – Present

Education

University of California, Berkeley

PHD IN ELECTRICAL ENGINEERING AND COMPUTER SCIENCES

Advisors: Claire J. Tomlin and Gireeja Ranade

Berkeley, CA, USA
08/2022 – Present

Mercer University

BS IN ENGINEERING, ELECTRICAL SPECIALIZATION

GPA: 4.00/4.00

Macon, GA, USA
2018 – 2022

Research Experience

Massachusetts Institute of Technology

SUMMER RESEARCH INTERN

Laboratory for Information & Decision Systems (LIDS)
Moe Win (Advisor)

Cambridge, MA, US
Summer 2020

Mercer University

UNDERGRADUATE RESEARCHER

Makhin Thitsa (Advisor)

Macon, GA, US
2019 – 2022

Publications

* first author(s)

JOURNAL ARTICLES

[J2] **Ebonye Smith***, Sampada Deglurkar, Jingqi Li, Gechen Qu, and Claire J. Tomlin. “From Global to Local: Hierarchical Probabilistic Verification for Reachability Learning”. In: *IEEE Control Systems Letters* 10 (2026), pp. 2137–2142

[J1] Sampada Deglurkar, **Ebonye Smith**, Jingqi Li, and Claire J. Tomlin. “Active Calibration of Reachable Sets Using Approximate Pick-to-Learn”. In: *IEEE Control Systems Letters* 10 (2026), pp. 1975–1980

CONFERENCE PAPERS

[C1] **Ebonye Smith***, Aidan Andrews, Phoenix Wilson, Ayush Pandey, and Gireeja Ranade. “How do Transformers Perform Low-Level Control In-Context?” In: *Proc. of the IEEE Conference on Decision and Control (CDC)*. Accepted. 2026

OTHER PUBLICATIONS

[O1] Chinekwu Obidoa, Onah P Thompson, Makhin Thitsa, **Ebonye Smith**, and Harold Katner. “Sexual Behavior Patterns of Black Young Adults in Georgia: Results from a Latent Class Analysis”. In: *Journal of Racial and Ethnic Health Disparities* 10.1 (2023), pp. 271–281

Invited Talks

2026

ANSR Seminar, UC Berkeley

Mentoring

Spring 2026	Undergraduate Research Assistant · UC Berkeley Advising 1 student on a research project regarding in-context learning capabilities of Transformers
Summer 2025	Summer Undergraduate Program in Engineering Research (SUPERB) · UC Berkeley Advising 1 student on a research project regarding in-context learning capabilities of Transformers

Professional Experience

2021 – 2023	Technical Intern · Cisco Systems
Summer 2019	Software Development Intern Manager · TaxSlayer

Teaching Experience

Spring 2021	EGR 246L: Electric Circuits Laboratory · Mercer University Teaching assistant and lab instructor · Undergraduate Level (~30 Students)
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Service to the Profession

COMMITTEES & ORGANIZATION

2025 –	Co-Organizer , Embodied Intelligence and Robotics (EMBER) Seminar Series, weekly campus-wide seminar studying the fundamental principles of embodied intelligence	UCB
2025	Equal Access for Application Assistance (EAAA) Reviewer , Assist underrepresented prospective PhD students on graduate school applications to help equalize access to guidance on the application process.	UCB
2025 –	Organizer , Hybrid Systems Laboratory Group Meeting	UCB
2024 –	EE Faculty Interview Committee , student interviewer for Prospective EECS faculty	UCB
2023	Student Reviewer , Application reviewer for Berkeley EECS PhD program	UCB

INITIATIVES

2026	Graduate Women in Engineering (GWE) College Prep Career Panel , Graduate student panelist for local high school graduate school career panel	UCB
2026	Path to the Professoriate (P2P) program's "Early Career Graduate Student Panel" , Graduate student panelist for a career panel designed to answer questions from first-year PhD students about the PhD journey	UCB
2021 – 2022	National Society of Black Engineers , Pre-College Initiative Chair, Created college information packets for underrepresented minority students in the Macon, GA community, spoke at a local elementary school's Career Day about higher education in engineering, and participated in weekly mentorship and tutoring of young Black women at a local elementary school	MU

PEER REVIEW

Conferences (reviewed 2 submissions): Conference on Decision and Control (CDC)

Awards, Fellowships, & Scholarships

2022	National Science Foundation Graduate Research Fellowship (NSF GRFP) , National Science Foundation
2022	Chancellor's Fellowship , University of California, Berkeley
2022	Outstanding Graduate in Electrical Engineering , Mercer University
2021	Barry M. Goldwater Scholarship , Barry Goldwater Scholarship Foundation
2019	Minority Mentorship Scholarship for Success , Mercer University
2019	Jesse Mercer Scholarship , Mercer University